

MARKET BRIEFING

The AI Agent Market

Autonomous software that plans, decides and acts is moving from demo to production line item. Here is what the numbers actually say in 2026 — including where the forecasts disagree.

Compiled 14 September 2026 · Sources: Grand View Research, Precedence Research, Mordor Intelligence, Research and Markets, Gartner, KPMG, Google Cloud

Headline numbers

Consensus: a ~\$8B market in 2025 compounding at roughly 45–50% a year.

\$7.6B

Market size, 2025

Grand View Research

\$10.9B

Expected size, 2026

Grand View Research

49.6%

CAGR to 2033

Grand View Research

\$182.9B

Projected by 2033

Grand View Research

The forecasts don't agree — and that matters

Same technology, five analyst houses, wildly different end points. Definitions of "agent" vs "agentic AI" vs "agent platform" drive most of the spread.

SOURCE	BASE YEAR	FORECAST	CAGR
Grand View Research	\$7.6B (2025)	\$182.9B by 2033	49.6%
Precedence Research	\$7.92B (2025)	\$294.7B by 2035	43.6%
Research and Markets	—	\$53.2B by 2030	44.9%
Mordor Intelligence agentic AI	\$6.96B (2025)	\$57.4B by 2031	42.1%
Gartner software revenue	—	~\$450B by 2035	—

Read the spread, not the point estimate. Every house agrees on direction (40%+ compounding) and disagrees on scope by a factor of five. Gartner's \$450B counts agentic capability embedded in enterprise software — roughly 30% of the total software market — not standalone agent products.

Adoption reality check

Pilots are near-universal. Production is not.

52% Executives with agents in production Google Cloud, ROI of AI	39% Of those run 10+ agents Google Cloud
40% Of enterprise apps will embed task-specific agents by end-2026 (from <5% in 2025)	53% Large US organisations with agents deployed KPMG AI Pulse, Q2 2026

9% → 18%

Multi-agent orchestration, doubled in one quarter

KPMG AI Pulse, Q2 2026

~45–50%

Annual market growth rate, cross-source

Composite

Where deployment is actually happening

Share of organisations running agents in production, by region.



North America holds ~39.6% of market revenue (Grand View Research), but Asia-Pacific is the fastest-growing region in most forecasts — driven by India, Singapore and Japan. Within regions, leaders diverge sharply: UK 33%, Germany 31%, Singapore 34%, Australia 31%.

What's driving it — and what's holding it back

Tailwinds

- **Tool use matured.** Function calling, MCP and structured outputs turned

Headwinds

- **The governance gap.** Deployment is outpacing controls — audit trails,

chatbots into systems that can transact.

- **Unit costs fell.** Cheaper inference makes multi-step agent loops economically viable where they weren't in 2024.
- **Measurable ROI.** Early adopters report real cost savings in support, coding and back-office workflows — enough to move budget from experiment to line item.
- **Platform gravity.** Hyperscalers and enterprise software vendors are embedding agents natively, removing integration work.

permissioning and rollback are frequently retrofitted.

- **Reliability compounds badly.** A 95%-reliable step run ten times in sequence is a ~60%-reliable workflow.
- **Pilot purgatory.** High experimentation, far lower production conversion — the gap between the two is the real story of 2026.
- **Definitional fog.** "Agent" spans scripted automation to autonomous planners, making vendor comparison and sizing unreliable.

Market structure

Four layers, different competitive dynamics in each.

Segments

- Single-agent
- Multi-agent orchestration
- Ready-to-deploy
- Build-your-own
- Customer service
- Coding & SWE
- Sales & marketing
- Back office / RPA replacement
- Security operations

Layers of the stack

- **Models** — frontier labs; agentic capability is now a primary benchmark axis.
- **Frameworks & orchestration** — planning, memory, tool routing, multi-agent handoff.
- **Infrastructure** — sandboxed execution, observability, evals, identity and permissioning for non-human actors.

- **Applications** — vertical agents sold on outcomes, increasingly priced per task rather than per seat.

Primary sources

Go here before quoting any of the above.

[Grand View Research — AI Agents Market, 2026–2033](#)

Free summary with segment and regional splits.

[Precedence Research — AI Agents Market to 2035](#)

Longest forecast horizon; country-level US data.

[Mordor Intelligence — Agentic AI Market to 2031](#)

Most conservative of the major forecasts.

[Research and Markets — AI Agents Market Report](#)

Near-term 2030 view.

Figures are third-party analyst estimates and survey results, reproduced as published and not independently verified. Market-sizing methodologies differ materially between houses; treat cross-source comparisons as directional.

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